

JULIAN TSANG

+1 (773) 571-2531 · jtsang327@gmail.com · [linkedin.com/in/julianhltsang](https://www.linkedin.com/in/julianhltsang)

EDUCATION

University of Chicago, USA · *Graduate coursework*

Spring Quarter 2026

- Real Analysis I: A (77/100 in the final exam, the top score in the class)

University of Oxford, UK · *MPhil in Economics*

Sep 2023 – Jun 2025

- Graduated with *Distinction*
- Relevant courses: Core Econometrics (73/100), Core Macroeconomics (70/100), Core Microeconomics (82/100), and Advanced Econometrics (73/100)
- Supervisor: Prof. Noam Yuchtman
- GRE: 165 for verbal; 170 for quantitative; 5.5 for analytical (top 3% among candidates)

University College London, UK · *BSc Economics*

Sep 2020 – Jun 2023

- Graduated with *First Class Honours* (average of 76/100 across three years based on the official weighting method)

La Salle College, Hong Kong

Sep 2014 – Jun 2020

- Scored 4A*s in Mathematics, Further Mathematics, History, and Economics (awarded Highest Mark in the World for Economics)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Professional, Becker Friedman Institute · *University of Chicago*

Jul 2025 – Present

- Worked with Profs. Esteban Rossi-Hansberg and Chang-Tai Hsieh to simulate and calibrate a dynamic model of firm innovation in which firms grow by improving the products they already make (scale) or by adding new ones (scope); matched the model to the employment and product-variety shares of the largest firms in the economy
- Worked with Profs. Esteban Rossi-Hansberg and Klaus Desmet to extend the spatial integrated assessment model of Cruz and Rossi-Hansberg (2024) to include a collapse of the Atlantic Meridional Overturning Circulation on a $1^\circ \times 1^\circ$ global grid; found that the collapse lowers welfare on net but reverses the welfare losses for the regions hardest hit by climate change
- Extended the dynamic spatial model of Desmet et al. (2025) to endogenize the cost of human capital accumulation; used the model to predict income convergence across space over the very long run
- Handled the revise-and-resubmit of “Local GDP Estimates Around the World” (Rossi-Hansberg and Zhang, 2026), accepted at the *Journal of Urban Economics*; designed uncertainty measures for the local GDP estimates and a variable-importance method to decompose the factors contributing to GDP divergence across grid cells

Writing Sample · “*Process Efficiency as a Barrier to Innovation*”

Oct 2025 – Present

- Studied why large firms in China produce little innovation despite receiving most government subsidies; built a Klette–Kortum quality-ladder model in which firms split their R&D budget between product innovation, which generates patents, and process efficiency, which lowers production costs on every product line
- Larger firms invest more in process efficiency in the model, so subsidies to large firms build a *moat* that crowds out small-firm patenting; found support for this prediction and the mechanism in firm-level data from the 2008–2020 Chinese Tax Survey

MPhil Thesis · *University of Oxford*

Oct 2024 – May 2025

- Studied whether Chinese prefectures whose leaders had prior ties to Xi Jinping grew faster after he took office in 2012, measuring ties by the past co-working of party secretaries and mayors; identification rests on these officials having been appointed in the administration before (and independently of) Xi’s unexpected consolidation of power
- Found that each connected leader predicts about 9% higher growth in real GDP per capita over 2013–2021, and each leader connected to the purged Bo Xilai about 31% lower growth
- Used LLMs to classify statements of political alignment in five national newspapers and the official WeChat accounts of about 300 prefectural governments, as a text-based alternative measure

Research Assistant to Prof. Shaoda Wang · *University of Chicago*

Oct 2024 – Jun 2025

- Used topic models, including Latent Dirichlet Allocation (LDA), to analyze 200,000 Weibo posts by Chinese entrepreneurs and document trends over time and across regions

- Developed and compared text classification prompts for the DeepSeek and OpenAI APIs to place social media influencers on a left-right spectrum; examined changes in entrepreneurs' political attitudes over time from forwarding patterns
- Constructed a measure of entrepreneur sentiment from the posts; ran LASSO on a large set of macroeconomic and firm-specific indicators to identify what drives sentiment, and linked it to government arrests of entrepreneurs

Research Assistant to Prof. David Yang · *Harvard University*

Apr 2024 – Feb 2025

- Collected policy documents for 900 Chinese government-guided investment funds; wrote Python code using LLMs to extract variables on the funds' geographical and sectoral investment requirements
- Extracted variables on industrial policy focus from national and provincial five-year plans and from annual reports of prefectural governments, 2001 to 2021, using regular expressions, text mining, and LLMs

Research Assistant to Dr. Andrea Bernini · *University of Oxford*

Jan 2024 – Sep 2024

- Helped address referees' comments in the revise-and-resubmit of a paper on NAFTA's effect on income inequality in Mexico, including concerns about the identification strategy and its limitations
- Wrote the section of a paper on the 1990 German reunification and East German gender differences in smoking that quantifies the implications for public health expenditure and the gender mortality gap

EARLIER RESEARCH PROJECTS

Quantifying the Macroeconomic Consequences of the Arab Spring · *advised by Prof. Fred Kwan*

Jun 2023 – Present

- Used the synthetic control method in R to estimate the long-run effects of the Arab Spring on per capita growth, life expectancy, income inequality, and unemployment

Economic Tribune, London, UK · *Research Fellow*

Oct 2022 – Jul 2023

- Wrote a 4,500-word paper on the impact of China's trade liberalization on provincial growth rates from 1992 to 2020, for the UCL Journal of Economics and the '23 Explore Econ Competition

Final-Year Independent Research Project, London, UK · *Student*

Oct 2022 – Jan 2023

- Wrote a 4,500-word literature review of new Keynesian models with wage and price rigidities, assessing their empirical relevance

UCL Explore Econ 2022, London, UK · *Finalist*

Jun 2022

- Estimated an expectations-augmented Phillips curve for Hong Kong; found high inflation persistence and a structural break in 1996, when expectations became more anchored

WORK EXPERIENCE

RBB Economics (economic consultancy), London, UK · *Intern*

Jun 2024 – Sep 2024

- Worked on a merger in the steel market for the UK jurisdiction; cleaned sales data to show the closeness of competition between the merging parties, in response to requests for information from the Competition and Markets Authority
- Worked on a cartel litigation case defending a group of Norwegian salmon producers; used data to argue the lack of intent to collude on prices and presented the analysis to the partner

Capital Pilot (venture capital firm), London, UK · *Consultant*

Apr 2022 – Jun 2023

- Assessed over 150 startups from pitch decks and financial models; developed metrics adopted in the firm's Investibility Rating System, used for the £5M Boost Fund's first-round investments

Equinix (global data center provider), Hong Kong SAR · *Intern*

Jun 2022 – Sep 2022

- Cleaned large datasets and built Excel and Tableau tools to forecast sales; presented the tools to analysts across APAC

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- **Citizenship:** Hong Kong SAR
- **Languages:** English (IELTS 8.0), Mandarin, and Cantonese
- **Interests:** Piano, Scouting, Skiing, Mahjong, Volunteering, and Traveling to Ethnic Minority Areas in China